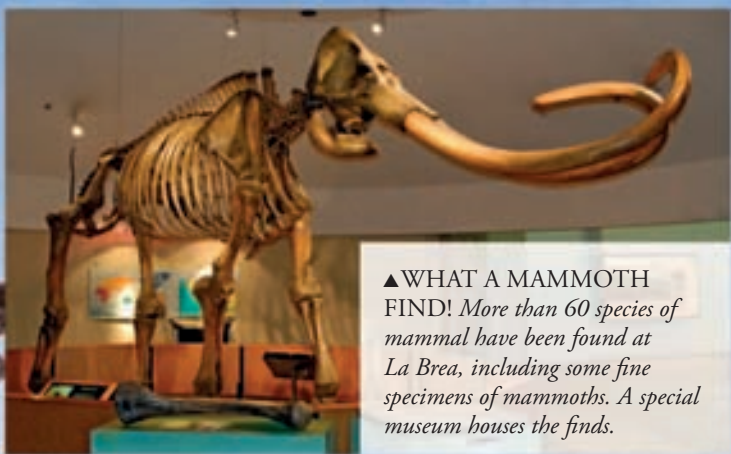




▲ **WHAT A MAMMOTH FIND!** *More than 60 species of mammal have been found at La Brea, including some fine specimens of mammoths. A special museum houses the finds.*

MORE PREDATORS THAN PREY?

One interesting fact shown by the fossils at La Brea is that more than 90 percent of the mammals are carnivores. Why? Perhaps it's because if a single herbivore became trapped, its struggles would draw predators and scavengers hoping for an easy meal, who in turn became trapped.



▲ **SKULLS** *More than 4,000 dire wolves have been discovered in La Brea tar pits. Dire wolves became extinct some 10,000 years ago.*

Altogether, more than **3.5 million specimens** have been recovered from La Brea, representing nearly **650 species** of plant and animal.



FACT FILE

All these animals have been found at La Brea.

Herbivores

- Mammoth
- American mastodon
- Ground sloth
- Shasta ground sloth
- Ancient bison
- American camel
- Stilt-legged llama
- Horse
- Pronghorn
- Tar-pit pronghorn
- California tapir
- Elk (wapiti)
- Deer

Carnivores

- Short-faced bear
- Brown bear
- Black bear
- American lion
- Saber-toothed cat (Smilodon)
- Jaguar
- American cheetah
- Cougar
- Dire wolf
- Gray wolf
- Coyote
- Weasel

Birds

- California condor
- Eagle
- Hawk
- Falcon
- Vulture
- Sandhill crane
- Canada goose
- Mallard duck
- Night heron
- La Brea stork
- Grebe
- Cormorant
- Magpie
- Great horned owl
- La Brea owl
- Greater roadrunner
- Band-tailed pigeon
- Curlew
- California quail

Reptiles, amphibians, and fish

- Kingsnake
- Garter snake
- Pond turtle
- Rainbow trout
- Rattlesnake
- Salamander
- Three-spined stickleback
- Tree frog
- Toad

